

SDG Goal 4 Quality education

SDG Target 4.b	By 2020, substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available to developing countries, in particular least developed countries, small island developing States and African countries, for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes, in developed countries and other developing countries
SDG Indicator 4.b.1	Volume of official development assistance flows for scholarships
Time series	ODA (gross disbursements) for imputed student costs

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: February 20, 2026
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/4-b-1>
- Definition: The time series measures the sum of gross disbursed official development assistance (ODA) from Germany for imputed student costs. These are estimated costs of students attending higher education institutions financed by Germany who do not receive individual grants. ODA for imputed student costs are identified by code E02.
- Disaggregation: Not available.

2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: September 2017
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-04-0B-01.pdf>
- The time series is not compliant with the UN metadata, but provides additional information. It shows the sum of gross disbursed official development assistance (ODA) from Germany for imputed student costs, while the UN metadata provides gross official development assistance received from the perspective of developing countries. The indicator refers to developing countries, which do not include Germany. Furthermore, it is important to note that the UN metadata do not outline the necessary purpose codes and/or types of aid.

3. Data description

- ODA is defined as financial flows to countries and territories on the OECD Development Assistance Committee (DAC) list and to multilateral international organisations that:

- i) provided by official agencies, including state and local governments, or by their executive agencies; and
- ii) concessional (i.e. grants and soft loans) and with the main objective of promoting economic and social development of developing countries.

The DAC list of ODA-eligible countries is usually updated every three years by the DAC based on the World Bank income categories.

Since the 1960s, Germany has reported annually its public and private resource flows for development cooperation to the DAC. Since October 2005, the Federal Statistical Office has been collecting and processing statistics on official development cooperation and other public and private flows to developing countries.

4. Access to data source

- OECD – Development Finance Data:
<https://www.oecd.org/dac/financing-sustainable-development/development-finance-data/>
- OECD – ODA for scholarships and imputed student costs [Selections: DAC1: Flows by provider (ODA+OOF+Private); Measure: 1510, 1520; Flow type: Disbursements, net]:
[https://data-explorer.oecd.org/?fs\[0\]=Topic%2C1%7CDevelopment%23DEV%23%7COfficial%20Development%20Assistance%20%28ODA%29%23DEV_ODA%23&pg=0&fc=Topic&bp=true&snb=20](https://data-explorer.oecd.org/?fs[0]=Topic%2C1%7CDevelopment%23DEV%23%7COfficial%20Development%20Assistance%20%28ODA%29%23DEV_ODA%23&pg=0&fc=Topic&bp=true&snb=20)

5. Metadata on source data

- General information on ODA as well as recent and future changes in methodology:
<http://www.oecd.org/dac/financing-sustainable-development/development-finance-standards/What-is-ODA.pdf>
- List of the OECD DAC purpose codes and channel codes:
<https://www.oecd.org/dac/financing-sustainable-development/development-finance-standards/dacandcrscodelists.htm>
- OECD – ODA to the forestry sector:
[https://data-explorer.oecd.org/vis?fs\[0\]=Topic%2C1%7CDevelopment%23DEV%23%7COfficial%20Development%20Assistance%20%28ODA%29%23DEV_ODA%23&fs\[1\]=Sector%2C0%7CALL%20sectors%231000%23&pg=0&fc=Sector&snb=18&df\[ds\]=dsDisseminateFinalDMZ&df\[id\]=DSD_CRS%40DF_CRS&](https://data-explorer.oecd.org/vis?fs[0]=Topic%2C1%7CDevelopment%23DEV%23%7COfficial%20Development%20Assistance%20%28ODA%29%23DEV_ODA%23&fs[1]=Sector%2C0%7CALL%20sectors%231000%23&pg=0&fc=Sector&snb=18&df[ds]=dsDisseminateFinalDMZ&df[id]=DSD_CRS%40DF_CRS&)

6. Timeliness and frequency

- Timeliness: t + 11 months
- Frequency: Annual

7. Calculation method

- Unit of measurement: Million EUR, Million USD, constant prices (2023)
- Calculation: Not applicable.

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SDG Indicator 4.b.1	Volume of official development assistance flows for scholarships
Time series	ODA (gross disbursements) for scholarships

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: February 20, 2026
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/4-b-1>
- Definition: The time series measures the sum of gross disbursed official development assistance (ODA) from Germany for scholarships. This includes financial aid awards for individual students and contributions to trainees from ODA recipient countries in Germany. ODA for scholarships are identified by code E01.
- Disaggregation: Not available.

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- List of the OECD DAC purpose codes and channel codes:
<https://www.oecd.org/dac/financing-sustainable-development/development-finance-standards/dacandcrscodelists.htm>
- List of ODA recipient countries:
<http://oe.cd/dac-list>

6. Timeliness and frequency

- Timeliness: t + 11 months
- Frequency: Annual

7. Calculation method

- Unit of measurement: Million EUR, Million USD, constant prices (2023)
- Calculation: Not applicable.